

A final point: choose your words and “level” of language depending on your intended readership. You don’t want your readers needing to refer to a dictionary as they’re reading your post—and neither do you want to sound simplistic to a sophisticated crowd.

3.6 Follow The Rules...

... of grammar and punctuation and so on. This point is an oft-overlooked one: you’ll see many blogs that don’t bother with proper punctuation and paragraph breaks and so on, but you will notice that the best—and most well-written—blogs do follow these rules.

It’s simple. There exist readers who can’t differentiate between a grammatically perfect blog post and one that’s written in a hurry with little attention being paid to such things as commas and full-stops, and those people won’t care. Yes, you aren’t doing *them* a favour by punctuating correctly. But what about that part of your readership that does care for such things? Poor language will certainly be a put-off.

It’s not to sound wise or very well-educated: it’s just that some people are linguistically sensitive, and are put off by laxity in grammar and punctuation. For best results, therefore, do spell-checks before posting. Microsoft Word doesn’t do a terrific job with its grammar checking feature, but one must admit it can help with common errors—you could try using that feature.

Coming to a more important point, we think there’s no famous blogger out there who uses SMS-speak, or teen-speak, or whatever you might care to call it: “ur” for “your” and such. Avoid such language like the plague, even if more and more people seem to be getting used to it! To a sensitive eye, it looks crass and uneducated. An uncapitalised “I” could mar your blog when it comes to such people! Again, you don’t need to care about people who don’t care—no-one’s going to tell you, “you shouldn’t have capitalised that ‘I’”!